

was associated with the UNIVAC team along with Eckert and Mauchly. Later versions like ARITH-MATIC, MATH-MATIC and FLOW-MATIC were released, and were used for business and scientific data processing.

1953

Transistorisation!

April: The 701

IBM unveiled the IBM 701, its first mass-produced computer for scientific use. It was significant in other aspects too; IBM had ventured from its core business of making punch card machines to making electronic computers. The 701 also launched the IBM



The IBM 701, also known as the Defense Calculator

700 series—702, 704, 705, and 709 which spanned the 1950s. Known as the Defense Calculator in the developmental stage, it stored data using a Williams-Kilburn tube (a type of cathode ray tube). The 701 used assembly language; from the 704 (completed in 1954) onwards, FORTRAN, invented by John Backus at IBM, was used as the programming language. The 701 was the first computer to demonstrate artificial intelligence by running a Samuel checkers-playing program.

November: A transistorised computer

A small computer was built using transistors—the first time vacuum tubes were not used in a computer. Built by Richard Grimsdale and Doug Webb at the University of Manchester, it